September 16, 2025 - 7:00 pm
School Council Minutes

Google Meet link: meet.google.com/dwi-suyj-rph

Chicopee Hills School Council Bylaws

- **Welcome (Erica)**
    a. Attendance/Introductions
    In attendance: Jenni Guy, Erica Quayle, Caitlin Coverdale, Kathleen Carr (White), David Cameron, Amit Trehan, Colleen Bishop, Kristen Gregson, Marisol Berdun, Ariana deVries, Jagraj Pattar, Dilraj Pattar, Marny Pelletier, Claudia Lawrence, Vesime Mehmet, Ioana Steenberg, Binah Straker

    What are parents looking for from Council this year?
    - More communication and engagement from Council
    - More collaboration of ideas and sharing
    - How we can enhance involvement by parents and others not on Council - give voice to the community
    - More staff involvement
    - Marny trying to encourage staff from each level junior, intermediate, primary to be involved at some level
    - More programming for students - clubs, teams, science fairs
    - Willing to help out with IT, event planning, marketing
    - Wants to see more supports for children - (newcomers) - social and academic

    b. Welcome message (Erica)
    Role of School Council includes: (in no particular order)
        i. Asking and implementing how we can best support Chicopee Hills staff and students?
        ii. Principal wants feedback on some decisions - parent input
        iii. Fundraisers
        iv. A place to raise concerns - but not individual concerns about teachers - these should be sent directly to the school Principal
        v. A place to learn - what's happening in the school, how is the school dealing with specific issues
        vi. A place to build community

c. Executive Positions available
    i. Chair
    ii. Vice-Chair
    iii. Secretary
    iv. Treasurer
d. Additional Roles that we could have for this coming year:
    i. WRAPSC Rep
    ii. Marketing & Social Media
    iii. Fundraising & Events
    iv. Volunteer Coordinator

- **School Update (Jenni)**
    a. June/Summer Update
        - End of June - kindergarten enhancements were put in
        - One of original soccer goal frames died - both have now been replaced with new nets
        - Sept 2 - PD Day - health and safety training
        - Sept 3 - first day of school
        - Sept 8 - library opened - JK -6 one class period per week in the library, grade 7 & 8 come every other week - students can come at any time with teacher permission to engage their books
        - Sept 9 - welcome back assembly
        - Sept 10 - School Council Food Truck/Fall open house - very well attended
        - Extra-curriculars starting:
            - 2 intermediate teams - girls field hockey and boys football
            - Interschool play starts at grade 7
            - Was the football program reduced this year?
            - Starting co-ed cross-country - just intermediate
            - All teams are run by teachers
            - Parents can initiate a club, but need a teacher contact - teacher will need to able to attend/help
            - Under development is a grade 7 & 8 Dungeons and Dragons club
            - Talked about a Kindness Club - primary level - more information to come
            - Intermediate Leadership group - similar to student council
            - Lunch helpers - junior level - starting

    - Trailblazers - students who walk to and from school and model good walking habits for youngers and support younger
- Bus Patrol training - Sept 18
- Sept. 22 - School Photo day - everyone will get a class composite (for free)
- Sept. 24 - trailblazer training
- Fall drills - fire drills
- Sept. 25 - Terry Fox event - to raise money for cancer research
- Sept. 29 - lockdown drills
- Sept 30 National Day for Truth and Reconciliation - orange shirt day
- October 10 PD Day

School Board sent out an email saying to follow the school calendar - Chicopee calendar has no updates - we have not been using it
We will start to use it - Jenni to start to add important dates

- **Financial Update (Caitlin) - no update since June**
    a. Spring BBQ = 131.85
    b. Big Box of cards = $1071.00

    OUTDOOR LEARNING: $8,097.80
    WEFI: $1,558.48

TOTAL: $26,061.26

Reminder regarding **Mabel's Labels** - keep spreading the word to use it - we have approximately $63 in the fund. We get a cheque whenever we hit $50.

Factory Shoe - continues to stay open - spend $30 and $5 goes to the school, just tell the cashier that it's for Chicopee. Will give an updated figure in October

- **Fundraising & Events Update (Erica)**
    a. What our funds paid for last year! - Jenni will provide a full list at October meeting as some of the items have not yet been delivered and therefore, the payments have not come out of our account yet.

    b. **Meet the Teacher/Food Trucks** - feedback
    Food trucks that attended: Fo Cheezy, MegaCone, Berry Bri & Beans, Schmuck N' Gourmet, The Serial Griller and Pablas Food truck

- We had 1 too many savoury trucks
- We should not have had Schmuck & Serial Griller together as their menus were too similar
- We asked for $100 or 10% of profit
- Three trucks paid in cash - Mega Cone paid more than $100, others paid $100. The remaining three will pay via WEFI - we will need to watch for those payments
- Pablas truck owner was disappointed that there were so many trucks, they were not busy and they closed up early (they probably will not come back in the future)
- Remaining trucks said that they would return
- We had 1 too many trucks in total
- It was better profit for Council than bbq
- Easier to organize than bbq
- Can we subsidy for families in the past? Can we figure it out for next time
- The line-ups were not too long
- Tables and chairs would have been nice
- Activities would have been nice
- Would like to see it in the spring instead of bbq

c. Holiday Market

Date: Saturday, December 6 - 11 am - 3 pm

- Email sent to vendors on Sept. 15
- We already have 5 vendors signed up and paid (via e-transfer)
- A lot of interest from previous vendors
- We would like to add more vendors and extend down the primary hallway
- Some concern expressed for those vendors that were not busy - but it is their choice whether to return
- We will reach out to Papa John's to have a lunch option - see if they will sell via the slice rather than just whole pizzas, if they will not, then we will reach out to other pizza franchises

D. **Other events planned:**

Science Fair
Book Fair
Airbands

Pizza nights in October

- we previously used Delicious Pizza - do we go with another franchise as their pizzas are more expensive? (and different from what the students get for hot lunches) - Dominoes is an option - Monday/Tuesday/Wednesday - you get a code - for every large pizza they donate $7 to the school or coupon for $15 and school gets $9 Dominos is cheaper that Delicious pizza; however they are further away and some parents don't want to fight the traffic down Fairway Road

- What about Ginos? Or Little Caesars?
- Kat was going to talk to the franchise owner at Subway to see if they would also do something similar - franchise owner is a parent of a student at Chicopee

Ariana to follow up on that

FYI - Hot lunches start Sept 29

<u>Other Business</u>

- **Idea for use of money** - each teacher gets a budget to spend - teachers used it to develop math problem - they decide what they did with it - develop with the students - incorporate the learning - debates what to use and purchase

- We would like to either work towards a specific large item to purchase or a specific dollar amount. What are we working towards? Need some motivation

- Next School Council agenda item - what did we buy at the end of last year - Jenni to create a list

- We will now allow for purchases to be made throughout the year, not just at the end of the year. Colleen has created google form for teachers to request for assistance throughout the year
  - depending on the amount of the request, we should have the teacher come to the Council meeting to give their proposal and then they can tell Council what they are doing in the school - Marny to put that together in an email to send out to staff

- Does anyone want to take on the **Outdoor learning project**?? We can start developing the back school ground in smaller chunks because there is no movement on getting money from other sources

- **Voting members -** do we need to strictly adhere to the by-laws? We don't want people only showing up when we are deciding what to spend our money on, they need to be present for debates/discussions on the purchases. We won't change the by-law in case we need to fall back on it if we can not come to a consensus. We will still need to create a list of voting members (this should be an agenda item for the next meeting - who wants to be a voting member)

HOT TOPICS - what do you want to learn about? We plan to do 10-15 minute sessions as part of School Council meetings - whether it is guest speakers or teacher presentations. Parents to bring ideas to October meeting as to what they want to learn about.

- Request was made that we send out minutes closer to when the meetings actually take place for review. We will do our best.
- Minutes will also be attached to next agenda for review

Movie Nights - can we divide it out into smaller groups? Maybe primary/junior/intermediate? - Executive decided to skip it this year - however, we can always add it back in if parents want to volunteer to help out with it.

Clubs/Sports - if parents wish to start a club or coach a team, they must have a teacher contact. Jenni is always happy to put the idea out to the staff to see if there is anyone willing to be that contact person.

Timing of Meetings: It was agreed to move meetings back to 6:30 instead of 7:00. We will do our best to keep meetings as short as possible.

Grant received - the Grant that we were expecting to receive in June to plant trees and add benches was significantly less than expected and we have been told that it can only be used for trees. We will be getting some additional trees, but if we want the benches, we will have to fund them ourselves

<u>ELECTIONS:</u>

- CHAIR - Erica Quayle
- VICE CHAIR - Kat Oue
- SECRETARY - Martin Stangl (Kathleen Carr to help out when Martin can't)
- TREASURER - agreed to combine with secretary

Ashley Legue - interested in a position, not present, didn't specify which position

WRAPSC - Marny Pelletier

TASKS FOR NEXT MEETING:

1. Bring ideas for what we want to work towards - money or item?
2. Bring ideas for what you want to learn in Hot Topics portion of Council meetings?
3. Bring ideas for what you want to do - fundraisers/events?
4. Bring ideas for building school community
5. Bring a friend! Spread the word about Council

Contact email (chicopeehills.council@gmail.com)

Next meeting **October 21 @ 6:30 pm**